Party was in power. I saw firsthand how the welfare state sapped incentive to work from many people in a wonderful and dynamic country.

Probably because of my dad's influence and my experiences during the Depression, I had loved the Democratic Party. I agreed with Thomas Jefferson, its founder, who said: "Democrats consider the people as the safest depository of power in the last resort; they cherish them, therefore, and wish to leave in them all the powers to the exercise of which they are competent. . . the equal rights of every man and the happiness of every individual are now acknowledged to be the only legitimate objects of government."

But the party had begun to change drastically in the thirties. Jefferson repeatedly said that the best government was the *smallest* government, that "governments are not the masters of the people, but the servants of the people governed." Abe Lincoln once said, "The principles of Jefferson are the definitions and the axioms of a free society." But during the Depression, the Democrats began to repudiate many of these principles while creating a government that grew ever larger and increasingly demanded the right to regulate and plan the social and economic life of the country and move into arenas best left to private enterprise.

I guess I was beginning to form one of my own principles about government: There probably isn't any undertaking on earth short of assuring the national security that can't be handled more efficiently by the forces of private enterprise than by the federal government.

Our federal bureaucracy expanded relentlessly during the postwar years and, almost always with the best of intentions, it began leading America along the path to a silent form of socialism. Our government wasn't nationalizing the railroads or the banks, but it was